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BETTER CALENDAR

UI/UX Design Document

Native iPhone MVP with a scalable Apple-platform design system

Scope

Phase 0 product foundation and Phase 1 offline calendar experience

Prepared for product, design, engineering, and usability testing

VERSION 1.0 · AUGUST 2, 2026

Document Control

Field	Specification
Product	Better Calendar
Document	UI/UX Design Document
Version	1.0
Date	August 2, 2026
Primary platform	iPhone / iOS
Future platforms	iPadOS, macOS, watchOS
MVP scope	Local calendars, events, recurrence, reminders, search, day/week/month/agenda views, ICS import/export
Out of scope for this version	Google sync, Apple EventKit sync, Gmail, U-M SSO, cloud accounts, collaboration, AI scheduling

Design intent

Better Calendar should feel familiar enough that a first-time iPhone user can operate it immediately, while improving schedule density, free-time visibility, event creation speed, and future task integration.

How to Use This Document

- Product and design use it to approve scope, hierarchy, terminology, and behavior.
- Engineering uses screen identifiers, component rules, states, and acceptance criteria for implementation.
- Quality assurance converts acceptance criteria and edge states into test cases.
- Usability research uses the task flows and success metrics to create moderated and unmoderated studies.

Contents

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2	Users and jobs to be done
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1. Experience Vision and Scope

1.1 Product experience statement

Better Calendar is a calm, high-information calendar that helps users understand what is happening, what time remains, and what action to take next. The interface prioritizes schedule comprehension over decoration and speed over configuration.

1.2 Experience outcomes

Outcome	UX implication	MVP measure
Understand today instantly	Today, current time, conflicts, and next commitment must dominate hierarchy.	User identifies next event in under 5 seconds.
Create events quickly	Quick Add includes only the minimum required fields; advanced options are secondary.	Basic event saved in under 20 seconds.
Trust the calendar	Time zones, all-day events, recurrence, and deletion behavior must be transparent.	No silent event loss or unexplained time shifts.
Control information density	Views adapt to available width and reveal detail progressively.	Event titles remain readable at supported text sizes.
Recover from mistakes	Move, resize, and delete actions support visible undo and clear confirmations.	Common mistakes recoverable without recreating an event.

1.3 MVP design boundaries

- The MVP is offline-first and stores Better Calendar events locally on the iPhone.

- External account connection surfaces are represented only as future placeholders in architecture, not functional controls.
- Tasks and intelligent scheduling are not included; the calendar model leaves space for later time-block overlays.
- The app follows the device's system appearance instead of adding an independent theme selector.
- Advanced settings do not interrupt initial use; defaults are usable without onboarding configuration.

Non-negotiable

A calendar interface can be visually polished and still fail if recurrence, dates, or undo behavior is ambiguous. Interaction clarity takes priority over visual novelty.

2. Users and Jobs to Be Done

2.1 Primary persona: university power scheduler

Dimension	Definition
Context	A student using iPhone and Mac who manages classes, assignments, meetings, travel, exercise, and personal commitments.
Current behavior	Uses Google or Apple Calendar, notes, reminders, email, and mental tracking across separate systems.
Needs	Fast creation, dense week comprehension, reliable recurrence, clear schedule conflicts, and simple calendar filtering.
Frustrations	Too many taps, weak visualization of free time, duplicate accounts, inconsistent all-day behavior, and lost context when rescheduling.
Success	Can confidently answer: What is next? What is fixed? Where is my free time? What changed?

2.2 Core jobs to be done

Job	Trigger	Desired outcome
Capture a commitment	A date, class, appointment, or deadline is learned.	Save it before details are forgotten.
Plan a day	The user opens the app in the morning or before a work block.	Understand commitments and available time.
Change plans	A meeting moves or a study block needs adjustment.	Reschedule safely and see conflicts immediately.
Find something	The user remembers partial event information.	Locate the event through one search location.
Prepare for an event	A reminder arrives or the next event approaches.	Open time, location, link, and notes with minimal effort.
Recover from error	The user deletes, moves, or resizes accidentally.	Undo without rebuilding the event.

2.3 Priority usage contexts

- One-handed use while walking between classes.
- Fast checks from the lock screen or during a conversation.
- Detailed planning while seated, often in landscape or later on iPad/Mac.
- Low-light use at night and high-brightness use outdoors.
- Intermittent or absent network connectivity.

3. Experience Principles

#	Principle	Application
01	Schedule first	Navigation, animation, and chrome should recede behind calendar content.
02	Fast by default	The common path is short; advanced configuration is progressively disclosed.
03	One action, one result	Every edit has an immediate, visible effect and a clear recovery path.
04	Time is explicit	Dates, time zones, recurrence scope, and all-day behavior are never inferred invisibly.
05	Color supports meaning	Color identifies calendars and states, but labels and shapes provide redundant cues.
06	Gestures are optional accelerators	Every gesture has an onscreen or accessibility alternative.
07	Density adapts	The interface becomes more compact or detailed based on device size, orientation, and text size.
08	Future integrations remain attributable	Every event will eventually display its owner and source without changing the base layout.

Apple's current Human Interface Guidelines emphasize hierarchy, harmony with the platform, and consistency across sizes and displays. Better Calendar applies those principles through native navigation, system typography, adaptive colors, and familiar control behavior. [1]

4. Information Architecture

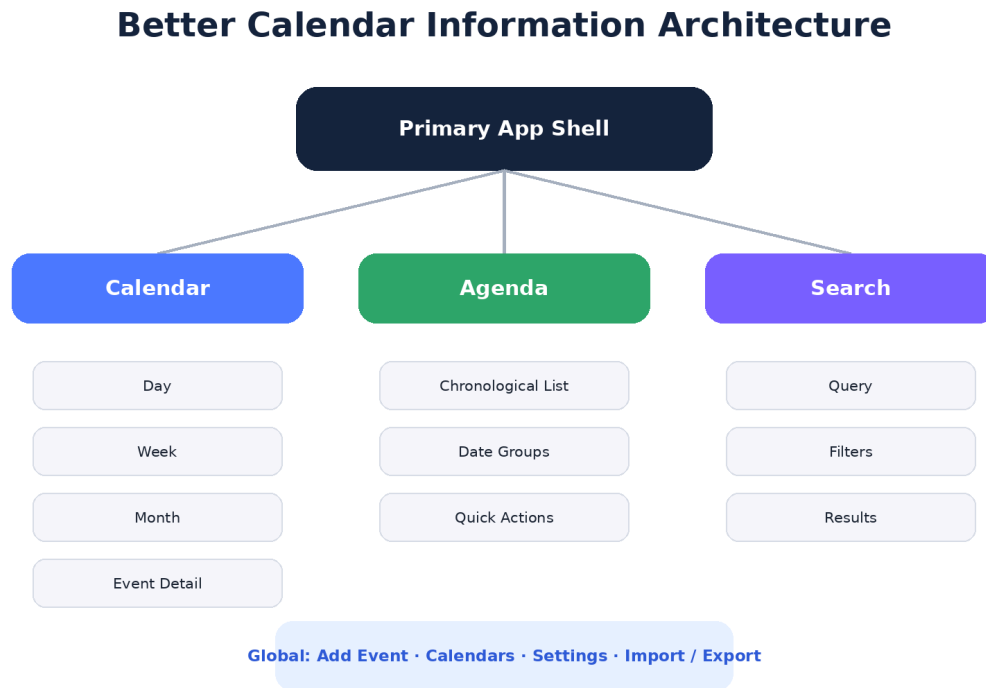


Figure 1. Phase 1 information architecture

4.1 Top-level destinations

Destination	Purpose	Default entry
Calendar	Spatial schedule views: day, week, and month.	Today in the last-used view.
Agenda	Chronological list optimized for scanning and quick actions.	Today, with nearby future events prefetched.
Search	Global search and filtering across all local events.	Empty state with recent or suggested filters, not private query history by default.
Calendars	Visibility, ownership, color, default selection, and deletion.	Presented as a sheet or secondary navigation destination.
Settings	Behavior defaults, display preferences, notifications, data import/export, and diagnostics.	Secondary destination from the profile/settings control.

4.2 Event object hierarchy

1. Calendar views display occurrences, not raw recurrence masters.
2. Selecting an occurrence opens Event Detail with source, time, location, recurrence, and actions.
3. Edit transitions to Event Editor and prompts for recurrence scope when needed.
4. Delete and move actions commit locally, display Undo, then perform notification reconciliation.
5. Search results open the same Event Detail screen to preserve consistent behavior.

5. Navigation Model

5.1 Primary navigation

Use a bottom tab bar with Calendar, Agenda, and Search. The currently selected destination is persistent. Add Event is a prominent contextual action, not a fourth destination.

Element	Behavior	Rationale
Tab bar	Persistent on primary screens; hidden in full-screen editors when necessary.	Keeps the three highest-frequency destinations one tap away.
View switcher	Segmented Day / Week / Month control inside Calendar.	Changes representation without changing destination.
Today action	Returns to current date; first tap selects today, second tap may center current time.	Supports rapid temporal recovery.
Add Event	Floating or toolbar action, consistent on Calendar and Agenda.	High-frequency action receives strong visual priority.
Calendars	Toolbar control opens a visibility and ownership sheet.	Filtering should not displace the current view.
Settings	Secondary toolbar or menu action.	Low-frequency configuration remains accessible but quiet.

5.2 Navigation behavior

- Horizontal swipes move between adjacent days, weeks, or months only when they do not conflict with nested horizontal controls.
- Back navigation preserves scroll position and selected date.
- Modals are used for focused creation, editing, filters, and destructive confirmations.
- Deep links should open the event detail or target date, then preserve normal back behavior.
- Search is treated as a single global location because the product's content is conceptually unified. Apple's search guidance recommends a primary, clearly scoped search location when search is important. [5]

6. Design System

6.1 Visual personality

- Calm rather than playful: neutral surfaces, limited accent usage, and restrained motion.
- Dense but not cramped: information appears compactly while maintaining readable spacing and touch targets.
- Native but distinctive: system patterns with a recognizable Better Blue accent and clear calendar-color language.
- Trustworthy: destructive actions, sync ownership, and recurrence scope use explicit language.

6.2 Color tokens

Token	Hex / system role	Use
Better Blue	#4F7CFF	Primary action, selected state, current date, focus accent.
Better Blue Dark	#315BD8	Text on pale blue surfaces and emphasized links.
Navy	#17233C	Primary text and high-emphasis headers.

Token	Hex / system role	Use
Ink	#1D2433	Body text.
Secondary Gray	#5D6678	Metadata and supporting labels.
Border	#D9DEEA	Dividers, card outlines, and inactive controls.
Surface	System background / #F5F7FB reference	Grouped fields and subtle depth.
Success	#2FA96B	Confirmed or completed state.
Warning	#E68A2E	Potential conflict or attention state.
Destructive	#D94C4C	Delete, cancellation, and errors.

Implementation should prefer semantic system colors for backgrounds and text, with custom colors supplied in light, dark, and increased-contrast variants. Apple recommends system colors where possible and warns against using color as the only differentiator. [3]

6.3 Calendar color behavior

- Calendar color appears as a leading rail or dot, not a full saturated background for every event.
- Timed event cards use a pale tint derived from the calendar color with high-contrast text.
- All-day events may use a stronger fill because they occupy less vertical space.
- Conflict state adds an icon, outline, or label; it does not rely on red tint alone.
- At least eight curated colors should be tested in light, dark, and increased-contrast settings.

6.4 Typography

Role	Recommended style	Usage
Large title	Large Title / Title 1	Date or destination title where space permits.
Section title	Title 2 / Title 3	Agenda date groups and modal titles.
Event title	Headline or Body Semibold	Primary event identification.
Event metadata	Subheadline or Footnote	Time, location, calendar, recurrence.
Control label	Body / Callout	Buttons, segmented controls, form rows.
Micro label	Caption 1	All-day, time-grid labels, secondary annotations.

Use the system font and Dynamic Type text styles. Layouts must adapt across all supported text sizes rather than scaling a fixed pixel specification. Apple’s typography guidance specifically recommends testing layouts at larger accessibility sizes and minimizing truncation. [4]

6.5 Spacing and sizing

Token	Value	Use
4	4 pt	Micro gaps and icon/text optical correction.
8	8 pt	Tight component spacing.
12	12 pt	Event-card internal spacing.
16	16 pt	Standard screen margin and grouped rows.
24	24 pt	Section separation.
32	32 pt	Major modal or empty-state separation.
44 minimum	44 x 44 pt	Baseline interactive touch target.
56	56 pt	Primary floating action diameter target.

6.6 Components

Component	Specification
Event card	Leading calendar rail, title, time, optional location, optional status icon. Minimum visible height supports one-line title and time.
All-day chip	Compact rounded rectangle, calendar tint, one-line label, overflow behavior.
Date header	Day/date, optional weather or secondary information later, Today state, selected state.
Segmented view switcher	Day / Week / Month, persistent within Calendar.
Time grid	Hour labels, subtle lines, current-time rule, optional 15/30-minute snap markers during interaction.
Form row	Label left, current value right, disclosure or inline control where appropriate.
Undo banner	Action summary plus Undo; never obscures the primary Save or destructive confirmation.
Filter chip	Compact, removable, and labeled with active scope.
Empty state	Short explanation, primary action, optional illustration; no blame-oriented wording.
Conflict badge	Icon plus text or outline, with details available on selection.

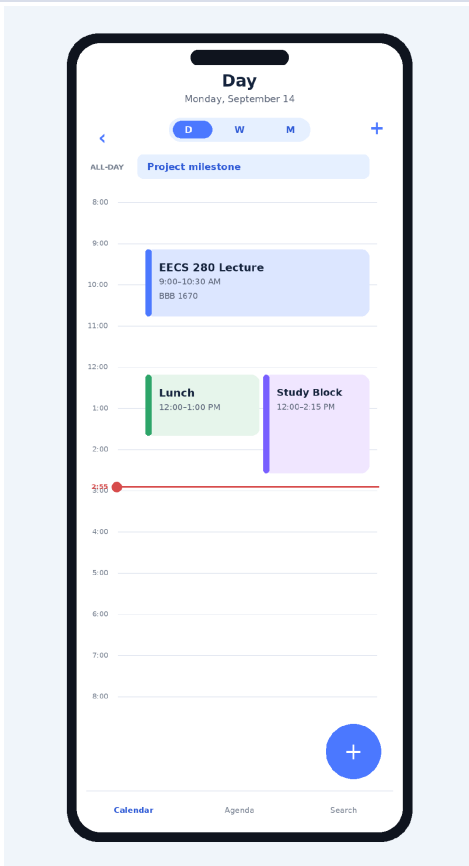
6.7 Iconography and motion

- Use SF Symbols for standard calendar, search, add, location, link, reminder, recurrence, visibility, and navigation actions.
- Use filled symbols only for selected states or high-priority actions; use consistent rendering modes.
- Motion should clarify continuity: date-page transitions, event movement, editor presentation, and undo recovery.
- Respect Reduce Motion by replacing spatial transitions with fades or immediate state changes.
- Haptics confirm drop, snap boundary, save, and destructive completion, but are not required to understand state.

7. Core Screen Specifications

The following screens define the Phase 1 experience. Each specification includes purpose, information hierarchy, interactions, states, and acceptance criteria.

7.1 Day View · CAL-DAY-01



Purpose

Provide the clearest representation of today or a selected date, emphasizing current time, overlaps, event duration, and available gaps.

Primary actions

- Navigate dates
- Return to today
- Open event
- Create at selected time
- Drag or resize event
- Switch calendar view

Content hierarchy

- Date title and view switcher
- All-day row
- Time grid and current-time indicator
- Timed event cards
- Persistent Add Event action
- Primary tab bar

Interaction rules

- Tap empty time to prefill Quick Add
- Tap event for Event Detail
- Long-press and drag to move
- Drag resize handles after selection
- Snap to 15 or 30 minutes with haptic feedback
- Auto-scroll near viewport edges

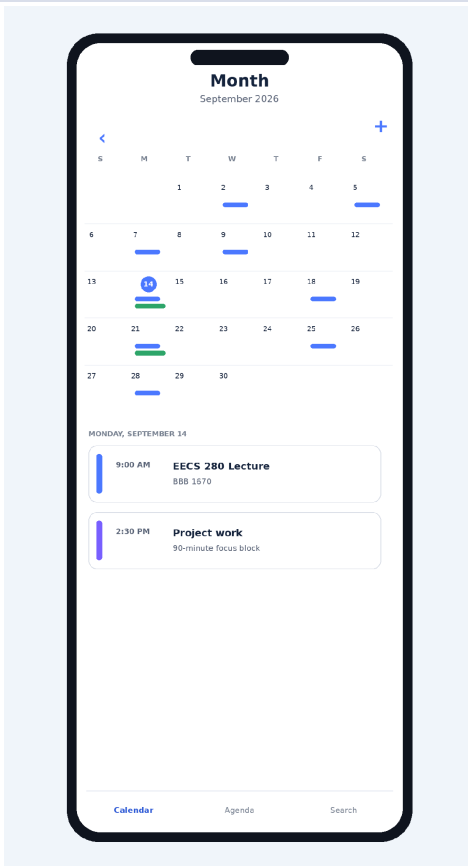
States

- Empty day
- Past date
- Today with current-time rule
- Overlapping cluster
- Overnight event
- Large text simplified layout
- Hidden calendars excluded

Acceptance criteria

- Next event is identifiable within five seconds
- No event card text overlaps another card
- Movement commits only on drop
- All drag actions have edit-form alternatives
- Current-time rule updates while active

7.2 Month View · CAL-MONTH-01



Purpose

Support date-oriented planning, recurring-pattern recognition, and rapid movement between a month overview and a selected day's agenda.

Primary actions

- Move between months
- Select date
- Open event
- Create event on date
- Jump to today
- Switch to day view

Content hierarchy

- Month and year
- Weekday labels
- Calendar grid
- Today and selected states
- Event markers or bars
- Selected-day agenda

Interaction rules

- Tap date to select
- Second tap or event tap opens detail/day view
- Swipe horizontally between months
- Long-press date to create
- Continuous bars represent multi-day events where space permits

States

- Month with no events
- High-density month
- Selected date with no events
- Multi-day event crossing week boundary
- Large text list-forward layout

Acceptance criteria

- Selected date is distinct from Today
- Events do not rely on dots alone at accessibility sizes
- Month navigation preserves selected day where valid
- Overflow count is actionable

7.3 Quick Add · EVT-QUICK-01

The mockup shows a mobile app interface for creating a new event. At the top, the title 'Quick Add' is displayed with the subtitle 'Create an event without friction'. Below this is a 'New Event' section with a 'Save' button in the top right corner. The form includes several sections: 'Title' with a text input containing 'Calculus review'; 'WHEN' with 'Starts' and 'Ends' fields set to 'Today, 7:00 PM' and 'Today, 8:00 PM' respectively, and an 'All-day' toggle switch; 'CALENDAR' with a dropdown menu showing 'School'; 'REMINDER' with a dropdown menu showing '15 minutes before'; a 'More Options' button; and a 'Natural-language option' section with a placeholder text 'Study tomorrow at 7 for 90 minutes'.

Purpose

Capture a basic event rapidly without forcing the user through every possible property.

Primary actions

- Enter title
- Adjust start/end
- Toggle all-day
- Select calendar
- Set a reminder
- Open More Options
- Save or cancel

Content hierarchy

- Title receives initial focus
- When group
- Calendar
- Reminder
- More Options
- Save action

Interaction rules

- Default start is the next sensible boundary
- Default duration is user-configured, initially one hour
- Changing start preserves duration until end is manually edited
- Save is enabled when date validation passes
- Keyboard action can submit

States

- Blank draft
- Validation error
- Notification permission not granted
- Unsaved changes
- Recurring preset selected
- Natural-language parsing future placeholder

Acceptance criteria

- Basic event can be saved in under 20 seconds
- No more than five primary field groups before More Options
- Cancel on untouched draft dismisses immediately
- Invalid end time is explained inline

7.4 Full Event Editor · EVT-EDIT-01

Purpose

Provide complete event control while maintaining scannable grouping and clear save, cancel, recurrence, and deletion behavior.

Primary actions

- Edit all event properties
- Change recurrence
- Add multiple reminders
- Move calendar
- Save
- Delete

Content hierarchy

- Title
- When
- Repeat
- Calendar
- Place and link
- Reminders
- Availability and privacy
- Notes
- Destructive action

Interaction rules

- Rows open inline controls or focused pickers
- Unsaved changes prompt on dismissal
- Recurring occurrence prompts for edit scope
- Converting all-day/timed preserves the most reasonable local date and duration
- Delete requires scope selection for recurring events

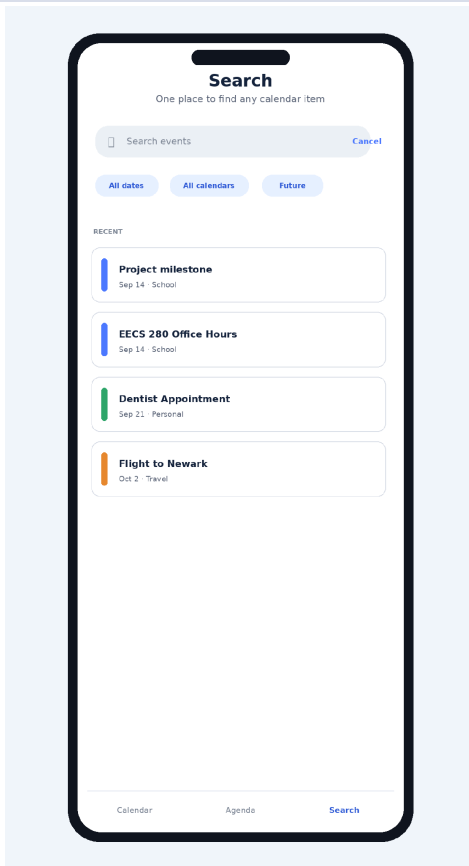
States

- New event
- Existing event
- Read-only future provider event
- Modified occurrence
- Validation error
- Notification permission denied

Acceptance criteria

- Field groups remain understandable at large Dynamic Type
- Save result is visible immediately
- Recurring scope language is explicit
- Destructive control is visually separated

7.5 Search · SRCH-01



Purpose

Find any local event from one clearly identified location using text, date, calendar, and event-type filters.

Primary actions

- Enter query
- Apply or remove filters
- Open result
- Clear query
- Return to previous destination

Content hierarchy

- Search field
- Scope/filter chips
- Suggestions or recent filters
- Ranked results
- Empty/no-result guidance

Interaction rules

- Search begins after a short debounce
- Exact and title matches rank ahead of notes
- Future results rank ahead of equally relevant past results
- Filter state is visible and removable
- Private query history is not shown by default

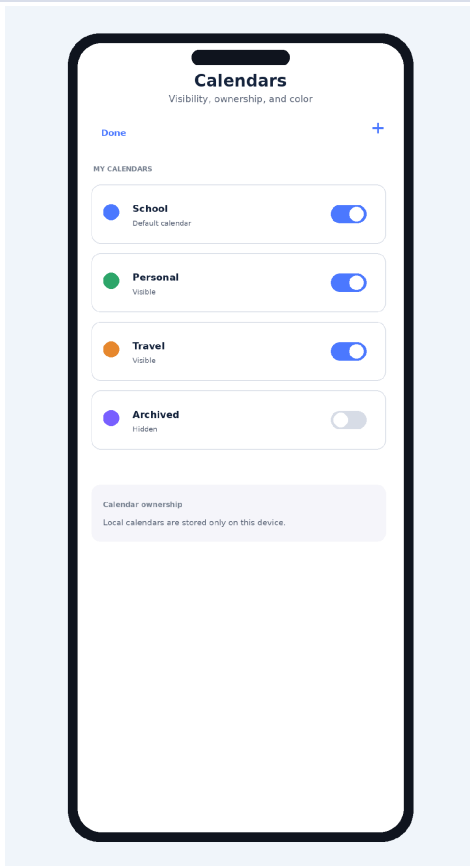
States

- Initial empty state
- Typing
- Results
- No results
- Index unavailable/rebuilding
- Large result set with pagination

Acceptance criteria

- Results appear within the performance target
- Current scope is always visible
- Query text is never logged or analyzed remotely
- VoiceOver reads result title, time, calendar, and location

7.6 Calendar Manager · CAL-MGR-01



Purpose

Control calendar visibility, naming, color, ordering, default ownership, and deletion without losing context in the current schedule view.

Primary actions

- Show or hide calendar
- Create calendar
- Rename
- Change color
- Set default
- Reorder
- Delete or move owned events

Content hierarchy

- Calendar group
- Color indicator
- Name and ownership state
- Visibility toggle
- Default status
- Add action
- Local-only explanation

Interaction rules

- Visibility changes preview immediately
- Done commits preference state
- Default calendar cannot be deleted without replacement
- Deleting a populated calendar offers move, delete-all, or cancel
- Color selection includes non-color labels

States

- Single calendar
- Many calendars
- Hidden calendar
- Default calendar
- Calendar containing events
- No calendars after data reset

Acceptance criteria

- Visibility is reversible
- Ownership is explicit
- No calendar deletion silently deletes events
- Color contrast passes both appearances

7.7 Week View · CAL-WEEK-01

Area	Specification
Purpose	Compare commitments and free time across several days while retaining enough event detail to support planning.
Portrait behavior	Use an adaptive three-day or horizontally paged week representation if a seven-day grid becomes unreadable.
Landscape behavior	Display all seven days with a persistent all-day row and shared vertical time scale.
Navigation	Swipe between periods, tap a date header for Day View, use Today to recover current week.
Event movement	Drag vertically to change time and horizontally to change day; announce destination date and time during accessibility interaction.
Density	Allow compact and comfortable density later, but use one validated default in Phase 1.
Acceptance	Event titles remain legible; horizontal and vertical scrolling do not compete unexpectedly; selected date remains identifiable.

7.8 Agenda · AGD-01

Area	Specification
Purpose	Present a chronological, list-based schedule optimized for scanning, large text, and quick actions.
Grouping	Sticky date headers; all-day events first; timed events in chronological order.
Loading	Fetch bounded date ranges and prefetch as the user approaches the end.
Quick actions	Open, edit, duplicate, move, and delete through context menus or swipe actions with button alternatives.
Past events	Visually de-emphasize without reducing contrast below accessibility requirements.
Empty days	Omit by default; optionally display a concise free-day marker when navigating a selected range.
Acceptance	Scrolling remains smooth with 10,000-event fixture; VoiceOver order matches chronology; Today jump is always available.

7.9 Event Detail · EVT-DETAIL-01

Area	Specification
Purpose	Provide a readable summary and launch point for all event actions.
Header	Calendar color/source, title, time, and status.
Content	Location, URL, notes, recurrence summary, reminders, availability, and future provider ownership.

Area	Specification
Primary actions	Edit, open link, open location, duplicate, move, share, export, delete.
Recurring occurrence	Show both occurrence date and recurrence summary; actions must prompt for scope where required.
Privacy	Do not surface private notes in screenshots, widgets, or notification previews unless the user allows it.
Acceptance	The next useful action is accessible without scrolling on typical events; every row has a meaningful accessibility label.

7.10 Recurrence Editor · REC-01

Area	Specification
Presets	Never, daily, weekly, every two weeks, monthly, yearly, weekdays, custom.
Custom fields	Frequency, interval, weekdays, monthly rule, end never, end after count, end on date.
Summary	Generate human-readable text such as 'Every 2 weeks on Monday and Wednesday, ends after 12 occurrences.'
Scope prompt	Use This Event, This and Future Events when supported, All Events, and Cancel.
Danger prevention	Show the number or range of affected occurrences when it can be calculated safely.
Acceptance	Summary updates as fields change; impossible rules are blocked or explained; daylight-saving behavior is not described misleadingly.

7.11 Reminder Editor · REM-01

Area	Specification
Presets	At time, 5/10/15/30 minutes, 1/2 hours, 1 day, 1 week, custom.
Multiple reminders	Show ordered rows; Add Reminder action remains available until a reasonable product limit is reached.
All-day behavior	Use a configurable alert clock time and clearly state the resulting date/time.
Permission denied	Retain the reminder configuration, show disabled system status, and offer Open Settings.
Acceptance	No repeated permission prompting; removing a reminder cancels its pending notification; time-zone changes trigger reconciliation.

7.12 Settings · SET-01

Group	Settings
Defaults	Default calendar, duration, reminder, all-day alert time.
Calendar display	First day of week, show weekends, default view, snap interval.
Time	12/24-hour display follows locale by default, time-zone override, optional secondary zone.
Accessibility	Reduce calendar animation; most accessibility behavior follows system settings rather than duplicating them.
Data	Import ICS, export calendar/date range, delete all local data.
About	Version, privacy, acknowledgments, feedback.
Diagnostics	Debug/TestFlight only: schema version, event count, notification reconciliation, sample data.

8. Interaction Patterns

8.1 Tap, press, drag, and keyboard behavior

Action	Primary behavior	Alternative
Tap event	Open Event Detail.	VoiceOver Activate.
Tap empty time	Open Quick Add prefilled with selected date/time.	Add button, then choose start time.
Long-press event	Enter move/resize mode or open context menu based on target.	Edit form with explicit date/time controls.
Drag event	Move; preview date/time and conflicts; commit on drop.	Edit start/end fields.
Resize handle	Change start or end with snapping.	Edit start/end fields.
Swipe period	Move to adjacent day/week/month.	Previous and next buttons.
Swipe list row	Reveal quick actions.	Context menu or Event Detail actions.
External keyboard	Command shortcuts for add, search, today, and view switching on iPad/Mac later.	Onscreen controls.

Apple's accessibility guidance recommends using simple gestures for common interactions and providing alternatives to gestures. Better Calendar therefore treats gestures as accelerators rather than the only way to complete an action. [2]

8.2 Drag-and-drop state model

- Press establishes selection and displays movement affordance.
- The event lifts visually and retains a ghost at its original position.
- A floating label announces proposed date and time.
- Conflict preview updates as the event crosses occupied intervals.
- Snap boundaries provide subtle haptic feedback.
- Drop commits one database transaction; cancel returns to the original state without writing.
- An Undo banner identifies the event and new time.

8.3 Save and dismissal

Situation	Behavior
Untouched new event	Cancel dismisses immediately.
Modified unsaved event	Dismissal asks Keep Editing or Discard Changes.
Successful save	Editor dismisses; destination view scrolls to or highlights the saved occurrence.
Database failure	Editor remains open with values preserved and a recoverable error.
Notification failure	Event saves; nonblocking warning explains reminders may not fire until permission or reconciliation succeeds.
Recurring edit	Scope is selected before commit, not after.

9. States, Errors, and Recovery

9.1 State inventory

State	Presentation	Required action
Loading	Prefer skeleton or immediate cached content; avoid blocking spinner for local queries.	None unless load exceeds threshold.
Empty calendar	Explain local-only state and show Add Event.	Create event or import ICS.
No search results	Repeat active scope and offer filter removal.	Edit query or clear filters.
Permission denied	Explain system-level impact and offer Settings link.	Open Settings or continue without reminders.
Validation error	Inline near the field plus summary if offscreen.	Correct field; preserve all input.
Import partial success	Show imported, skipped, and failed counts with details.	Review or export failure report later.
Database recovery	Use plain language; preserve a backup if possible.	Retry, export diagnostics, or reset only as last resort.
Destructive confirmation	Name the object and consequence.	Confirm or cancel.
Undo available	Temporary banner with action description.	Undo or allow expiry.

9.2 Error-copy rules

- State what happened in user language, not framework terminology.
- State whether the event was saved, not saved, or partially completed.
- Provide one primary recovery action when possible.
- Preserve entered data after recoverable errors.
- Do not blame the user or use vague labels such as 'Unknown error.'
- Do not expose event content in diagnostic identifiers.

9.3 Destructive action examples

Action	Recommended title	Body / options
Delete event	Delete "Calculus Review"?	This removes the event from this device. Delete / Cancel.
Delete recurring occurrence	Delete recurring event	This Event / All Events / Cancel.
Delete calendar with events	Delete "School"?	Move 42 events / Delete calendar and events / Cancel.
Delete all data	Delete all local calendar data?	This cannot be undone after the confirmation period. Export Data / Delete / Cancel.

10. Accessibility and Inclusive Design

Accessibility is a release criterion, not a post-MVP enhancement. Apple's guidance recommends supporting substantially larger text, simple interactions, gesture alternatives, Voice Control, and recoverability for difficult actions. [2]

10.1 Dynamic Type

- Support all iOS Dynamic Type sizes, including accessibility categories.
- At large sizes, convert dense grids into simplified cards or list-forward layouts rather than clipping text.
- Allow event titles to wrap where view density permits; retain full content in Event Detail.
- Scale meaningful SF Symbols with text styles.
- Avoid fixed-height form rows when text may wrap.

10.2 VoiceOver and Voice Control

Element	Accessibility behavior
Event card	Single grouped element by default: title, start/end, calendar, location, conflict status. Custom actions: Open, Edit, Move, Delete.
Time grid	Hour labels are navigational landmarks; empty time slots should not become hundreds of unnecessary focus stops.
Month cell	Read date, today/selected state, event count, and first event summaries; activate to select or open list.
Calendar color	Announce calendar name and visibility, not color alone.
Drag operation	Provide Move Event action with date/time picker; announce preview changes when direct manipulation is used.
Recurrence scope	Buttons use complete labels and explain the affected series.
Custom controls	Provide accessibility label, value, hint, traits, and predictable focus order.

10.3 Contrast, color, and appearance

- Use semantic text and background colors wherever possible.
- Test light, dark, increased-contrast, and differentiate-without-color settings.
- Use calendar rails, labels, icons, patterns, or outlines in addition to hue.
- Respect system Dark Mode instead of forcing a separate app preference. Apple advises apps to respond to the system appearance and to verify both light and dark designs. [6]
- Target strong contrast for small calendar text; avoid pale text placed directly on saturated calendar fills.

10.4 Motor and cognitive accessibility

- Minimum interactive target should generally be 44 x 44 points, with additional spacing between adjacent destructive and confirm actions.
- Avoid time-limited actions except Undo; provide enough duration and an alternative recovery path.
- Use consistent placement for Save, Cancel, Today, and Add Event.
- Keep recurring-event language concrete and show examples or summaries.
- Avoid exposing too many simultaneous controls in the quick path.
- Support Reduce Motion and avoid unnecessary parallax or continuous animation.

11. Responsive Platform Expansion

11.1 iPadOS

Pattern	Adaptation
Navigation	Three-column NavigationSplitView: calendar list, main schedule, inspector/detail.
Week view	Full seven-day grid in most orientations with drag-and-drop and hover/pointer states.
Event editor	Form in an inspector or resizable sheet while retaining schedule context.
Multitasking	Layouts adapt in Split View and Stage Manager; avoid assuming full-screen width.
Keyboard	Add event, search, today, view switching, date navigation, and save shortcuts.
Pencil	Optional direct selection and event creation; no Pencil-only functionality.

11.2 macOS

Pattern	Adaptation
Windowing	Multiple windows, resizable sidebars, persistent inspector, remembered window state.
Navigation	Sidebar and toolbar replace bottom tabs; command menu exposes all major actions.
Quick Add	Global shortcut and menu-bar entry point.
Interaction	Pointer hover, right-click context menus, drag-and-drop, keyboard-first editing.
Density	More columns and persistent metadata; user-adjustable sidebar and agenda widths.
System integration	Spotlight indexing, share extension, printable views, meeting-link menu bar item later.

11.3 watchOS

Pattern	Adaptation
Primary job	Glance at next event and today's agenda; take one immediate action.
Hierarchy	Time, title, location/link, and countdown; minimal secondary metadata.
Actions	Join, directions, accept/decline later, mark task complete later, snooze reminder.
Input	Dictation and App Intents for quick event capture.
Accessibility	Larger default text and limited scrolling; support at least 140 percent enlargement per Apple guidance. [2]
Complications	Next event, time until next event, and current focus block in later phases.

11.4 Cross-platform continuity rules

- Terminology and event ownership remain identical across platforms.
- Calendar colors, recurrence summaries, and conflict language remain consistent.
- Platform-native navigation replaces forced visual sameness.
- The same event identifier deep-links to the appropriate local presentation.
- Editing behavior and recurrence scope remain logically equivalent even when controls differ.

12. Usability Validation Plan

12.1 Research rounds

Round	Prototype	Participants	Focus
1. Concept	Low-fidelity clickable prototype	5–7 university students	Navigation labels, view switching, information hierarchy.
2. Interaction	High-fidelity iPhone prototype	6–8 mixed calendar users	Quick Add, recurrence, drag/resize, delete and undo.
3. Accessibility	Instrumented build	VoiceOver, large text, motor-access users where available	Focus order, alternate actions, layout adaptation.
4. Beta	TestFlight production-like build	20–50 users over 2–4 weeks	Reliability, performance, real schedule density, ICS compatibility.

12.2 Core usability tasks

13. Find the next event and state where it takes place.
14. Create a 90-minute event tomorrow at 7:00 PM in the School calendar.
15. Create a class that repeats every Monday and Wednesday for 12 occurrences.
16. Move one occurrence of a recurring event without changing the series.
17. Delete an event, then recover it using Undo.
18. Hide a calendar and restore it.
19. Find an event using a partial location or note keyword.

20. Import an ICS file and identify skipped duplicates.

21. Change the device time zone and explain why a timed event moved but an all-day event did not.

12.3 Success metrics

Metric	Initial target
Task completion	At least 90% for basic create, find, edit, and delete tasks.
Quick Add time	Median under 20 seconds for title/start/end/calendar/reminder.
Next-event identification	Median under 5 seconds from launch.
Critical error rate	Zero silent event-loss errors in testing.
Recurrence comprehension	At least 85% correctly predict scope before confirmation.
Undo discovery	At least 80% notice and can use Undo after a prompted mistake.
System Usability Scale	Target 80+ after feature stabilization.
Accessibility completion	All critical tasks completable with VoiceOver and at largest supported Dynamic Type.

12.4 Analytics boundaries

- Measure screen and action identifiers, durations, success/failure category, and performance timing.
- Never collect event titles, notes, locations, search queries, calendar names, or raw ICS content.
- Use local debug instrumentation before introducing production analytics.
- Document every analytics event and its privacy classification.

13. Developer Handoff and Release Checklist

13.1 Required design deliverables

- Figma library with semantic color, typography, spacing, icon, and component tokens.
- Responsive frames for standard and compact iPhone widths, landscape, and accessibility text sizes.
- Light, dark, and increased-contrast states.
- Component variants for default, selected, pressed, disabled, loading, error, read-only, and conflict states.
- Interaction prototypes for create, recurrence, move, resize, delete, undo, and search.
- Redlines or inspectable constraints, not screenshot-only specifications.
- Content inventory and localized-string keys.
- Accessibility annotations and expected VoiceOver order.

13.2 Definition of ready for engineering

Check	Required evidence
Scope approved	Screen and feature identifiers map to Phase 1 requirements.
States complete	Happy, empty, error, permission, and destructive states documented.
Responsive rules	Behavior specified for narrow width, landscape, and large text.
Data behavior	All-day, timed, recurrence, time-zone, and ownership rules linked to product specification.

Check	Required evidence
Accessibility	Labels, actions, focus order, gesture alternatives, and contrast verified.
Copy reviewed	Titles, actions, errors, confirmation language, and permission rationale approved.
Assets ready	SF Symbol names or vector assets documented; no ambiguous raster screenshots.
Acceptance criteria	Each primary screen has testable behavior and performance expectations.

13.3 Phase 1 design QA checklist

- ☐ Day, week, month, and agenda render correctly with empty, typical, and extreme event density.
- ☐ All-day and timed events remain visually distinct.
- ☐ Current time and Today states are visible but not confused with selected date.
- ☐ Overlapping events remain selectable and readable.
- ☐ Quick Add and Full Editor preserve user-entered data after errors.
- ☐ Recurring edit/delete scope appears before the change commits.
- ☐ Delete, move, and resize provide Undo.
- ☐ Dark Mode and increased contrast use appropriate semantic variants.
- ☐ Largest Dynamic Type does not clip primary actions.
- ☐ VoiceOver can complete all critical tasks.
- ☐ Notification-denied state does not repeatedly prompt.
- ☐ Search filters and scope remain visible.
- ☐ ICS partial import clearly reports outcomes.
- ☐ No user content appears in analytics or logs.

Appendix A. UI Copy Standards

A.1 Voice and tone

- Direct: ‘Event saved’ rather than ‘Your event has successfully been saved.’
- Specific: name the event, calendar, date, or consequence where privacy permits.
- Calm: avoid alarming language for recoverable problems.
- Actionable: errors tell the user what to do next.
- Consistent: use Create, Edit, Save, Move, Duplicate, Export, Delete, and Undo with stable meanings.

A.2 Recommended labels

Use	Avoid	Reason
Add Event	New Item	Names the object.
This Event	Only This One	Matches recurring-event mental model.
All Events	Entire Series Forever	Clearer and less dramatic.
Discard Changes	Close Without Saving	Focuses on consequence.

Use	Avoid	Reason
Open Settings	Fix Permissions	User controls system permission.
No events today	Nothing here	Specific and neutral.
Move Events	Keep Events	Names the actual action.
Import complete	Success!	Supports partial-result detail.

A.3 Permission rationale example

Notifications

Better Calendar uses notifications only for reminders you add to events. You can continue using the calendar without allowing notifications.

Appendix B. Screen Inventory

ID	Screen / surface	Release
ONB-01	Local-only onboarding	MVP
CAL-DAY-01	Day View	MVP
CAL-WEEK-01	Week View	MVP
CAL-MONTH-01	Month View	MVP
AGD-01	Agenda	MVP
EVT-QUICK-01	Quick Add	MVP
EVT-EDIT-01	Full Event Editor	MVP
EVT-DETAIL-01	Event Detail	MVP
REC-01	Recurrence Editor	MVP
REM-01	Reminder Editor	MVP
CAL-MGR-01	Calendar Manager	MVP
SRCH-01	Search	MVP
SET-01	Settings	MVP
IMP-01	ICS Import Preview	MVP
EXP-01	ICS Export	MVP
PERM-01	Notification Permission Education	MVP
ERR-01	Recoverable Error	MVP
UNDO-01	Undo Banner	MVP
ACC-01	Connected Accounts	Future
TASK-01	Tasks and Time Blocks	Future
AI-01	Schedule Suggestions	Future
BOOK-01	Scheduling Page	Future

Appendix C. References

- [1] Apple Human Interface Guidelines — [View source](#)
- [2] Apple Human Interface Guidelines: Accessibility — [View source](#)
- [3] Apple Human Interface Guidelines: Color — [View source](#)
- [4] Apple Human Interface Guidelines: Typography — [View source](#)
- [5] Apple Human Interface Guidelines: Searching — [View source](#)
- [6] Apple Human Interface Guidelines: Dark Mode — [View source](#)
- [7] RFC 5545: Internet Calendaring and Scheduling Core Object Specification — [View source](#)

Reference note

Platform guidance changes over time. The product team should recheck Apple's current Human Interface Guidelines and relevant developer documentation before final visual design approval and App Store submission.

Design approval gates

Product scope · Information architecture · Core flows · Component library · Accessibility · Usability results
· Engineering feasibility · Phase 1 design QA